▶ RAJASTHAN

SHARMA HITS RESET BUTTON FOR TOP BRASS

Bhajan Lal Sharma goes in for an overhaul of his police setup—all eyes on the moving Lego blocks

By **Rohit Parihar**



GAME OF SKILL CM Bhajan Lal Sharma with DGP Rajeev Sharma, to whom he delegated most choices

POLITICS IS NEVER ENTIRELY ABSENT from anything in India—bureaucratic reshuffles are hardly immune. So, an unstated fact fills out the context: Bhajan Lal Sharma is nearly two years into his chief ministership, and still engaged in a quest for greater authority. Still, the structural reset he has imparted to the Rajasthan Police's top echelons appears driven more by operational logic than anything else.

Given its eye-catching scale—with as many as 34 IPS officers put on new assignments—it's inevitable that some wonder whether vested interests were quietly at work. Especially since a few transfers did appear puzzling. But, overall, the visible hand is that of a professional, Director General of Police Rajeev Sharma, with the CM's approval. A tangible change from the norm, where the ruling party's top brass dictates the terms.

WHO'S ON TOP?

Notably, Director General (DG)-rank officers have been fielded to head crucial wings previously under Additional DGs. And a new post has been created—Special Commissioner (Operations) in the Jaipur Police Commissionerate—reflecting an intent to modernise policing at the top.

The new structure places DG Sanjay Kumar Agarwal in charge of law and order, with V.K. Singh, former chief of the Special Operations Group (SOG) and Anti-Terrorist Squad (ATS), returning as his ADG. DG Anand Kumar Srivastava, known for his deft handling of crises—including during the infamous attempt to topple the Ashok Gehlot government—has been brought back to the mainstream to head both the SOG and the ATS.

Takeaways

- **34 IPS officers given new assignments, DG-ranked cops to head crucial wings**
- **ATS strengthened anticipating terror activities; there is buzz around a few exits**

A much-discussed transfer is that of ADG Dinesh M.N. from Crime to the ATS. Dinesh, known for his pursuit of hardened criminals, will now oversee an area where narcotics, terrorism and organised crime overlap. His exit from Crime, which handles politically sensitive cases, signals a reordering of priorities. "Our focus areas have been white-collar and cyber crime, drugs, gangsters and terrorism," DGP Sharma told INDIA TODAY. IG Vikas Kumar, known for his strong record against drug traffickers in western Rajasthan, heads the unit. Also, the SOG has been separated from the ATS, an operational distinction long demanded.

ADG Vishal Bansal has been tasked with handling economic offences and modernising cybercrime capabilities. Rajasthan has emerged as a hotspot for digital frauds, with cybercriminals devising new ways to divert government subsidies and grants into mule accounts.

Perhaps the most visible change came in Jaipur Police, with the commissioner's post naturally a coveted and politically sensitive one. In a surprise decision, Congress-era appointee Biju G. Joseph was replaced with ADG Sachin Mittal, a low-profile officer. IG Rahul Prakash comes into the new post alongside: Commissioner (Special Operations). Besides the usual heartburn among officers who missed out on prime assignments, overall, it's gone down as a matter of bringing sharper operational focus. ■